

MICHEL MAYOR AND DIDIER QUELOZ

Born 1942 and 1966

When, in 1995, astronomers Michel Mayor and Didier Queloz were observing the star 51 Pegasi, they found out that it was being pulled back and forth by a planet. This planet (51 Pegasi b) – the first to be found around a Sun-like star, outside our Solar System – is almost as heavy as Jupiter, but it is so close to its parent star that it has been baked to almost 1,000°C (1,830°F). As a result, it is called a “hot Jupiter”.

Hot Jupiters orbit about 100 times closer to their parent star than Jupiter does to the Sun.

Michel Mayor

Didier Queloz

DATA FILE



KEY DISCOVERY: Found first planet around a Sun-like star



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: Switzerland



YEAR OF DISCOVERY: 1995